

Parallel One

Curate the Environment

Average leaders adapt to the environment. Strong leaders redesign it.

Leadership Model: CURATE

Put It into Play

Reflection Questions

Make time to reflect before you lead forward.

1. Where is my team experiencing unnecessary friction?

2. What conditions are helping people succeed, and what conditions are making success more difficult?

3. Am I delegating authority or simply assigning work?

Team Conversation Prompts

Use these questions to spark meaningful conversations with your team.

1. Do we understand what success looks like and why our work matters?

2. What unnecessary complexity have we accepted as normal?

3. Are we being asked to do too many competing things, and what can wait?

4. What is working well in our environment, and what should we redesign or stop doing?

Manager Conversation Prompts

Use these questions during your next one-on-one or performance discussion.

1. Where could I make expectations, priorities, or decision authority clearer for my team?

2. What barriers do you see that I could remove to make success more likely?

3. How can I encourage greater ownership while holding people accountable for outcomes?

Take Action

Which one or two of these actions would benefit my team and our performance most?

1. I will define success and explain how our work contributes to the organization's goals.

2. I will listen to my team and simplify one source of unnecessary complexity.

3. I will clarify tradeoffs and reduce competing demands on the team.

4. I will delegate authority and clarify accountability for outcomes.

5. I will assess what is working and intentionally improve one condition affecting performance.

